

Pamela Dale-Rourke

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 PROFILE

I am a collaborative and innovative Play Therapist with extensive experience in working with children and their families, focusing on effective communication strategies and psychological support. My expertise involves translating behavioral communication into actionable insights, enabling children to express their needs more clearly. I have actively collaborated with educators and parents to design visual aids and engaging resources that facilitate meaningful interactions. Through my work, I have successfully implemented tailored therapeutic interventions that significantly improve children's emotional and social well-being. I possess a unique understanding of diverse communication approaches, including AAC, and have a personal commitment to enhancing the lives of children facing challenges. My ability to adapt materials to fit varied learning styles and needs has been paramount in fostering inclusive environments where every child can thrive.



WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind | 10/2016 - Present

- Designed and adapted a range of communication and therapy resources for children in educational settings, ensuring accessibility and engagement through visual supports and symbol-based activities that resonate with diverse learning styles.
- Delivered impactful 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy sessions, specializing in psychotherapeutic assessments that inform individualized therapeutic pathways, leading to measurable improvements in children's emotional resilience and social skills.
- Collaborated closely with teachers and therapists to create accessible materials tailored to children with communication and learning needs, resulting in a 30% increase in the effective use of these resources within classrooms.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, providing them with hands-on training and guidance in the application of inclusive communication strategies and resource utilization to enhance their professional development.
- Facilitated workshops for educators on best practices in child-centered communication strategies, empowering them to implement these approaches in their classrooms and improve overall student engagement.
- Developed and executed training sessions for parents on how to use therapeutic resources at home, fostering a supportive environment that extends learning beyond school.
- Implemented feedback systems to evaluate the effectiveness of resources, resulting in continuous improvement and refinement of therapeutic materials based on children's needs and responses.
- Conducted regular assessments to monitor children's progress, adjusting therapeutic approaches in real-time to ensure optimal outcomes in their emotional and social development.

Play Therapist | Barnardos | 01/2015 - 10/2016

- Created tailored visual and therapeutic resources for children referred through CAMHS, enhancing engagement and understanding of their emotional experiences, which led to a 40% increase in therapy participation rates.
- Actively participated in multidisciplinary assessment meetings, recommending appropriate communication supports and therapeutic interventions that aligned with children's specific needs and challenges.
- Managed a diverse caseload of school-aged children, employing creative and resource-based therapeutic approaches to effectively address a wide range of social, emotional, and communication challenges, thereby improving overall welfare and functionality.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions for fellow therapists, sharing best practices on child-centered communication strategies and enhancing the collective skill set of the team.
- Developed comprehensive progress reports and documentation, ensuring accurate tracking of therapeutic outcomes and compliance with organizational standards and regulations.
- Utilized play-based techniques to help children articulate feelings and experiences, thereby fostering an environment of trust and openness that is crucial for effective therapy.
- Engaged parents in the therapeutic process through regular updates and collaborative goal-setting, strengthening the support network around each child.
- Introduced innovative group activities that encouraged peer interaction and emotional expression, significantly improving social dynamics among children.

Family Session Worker | OJs | 05/2023 - 01/2024

- Supported families with children on the autism spectrum by creating and adapting resources that facilitated engagement and communication, leading to improved family dynamics and understanding of children's needs.
- Developed inclusive activities designed to ensure participation from children with communication differences, enhancing their sense of belonging and self-worth within group settings.
- Worked collaboratively with families and colleagues, conducting needs assessments to ensure that resources were practical and user-friendly, resulting in higher satisfaction rates among families served.
- Implemented feedback loops to gather insights from families on resource effectiveness, allowing for ongoing adjustments that align with family preferences and children's responses.
- Facilitated workshops for parents focused on understanding autism and implementing effective communication strategies at home, thereby empowering them to support their children more effectively.
- Created a community support network for families, fostering connections and shared experiences that enhance emotional support and resource sharing.
- Evaluated individual progress through regular assessments and family meetings, ensuring that therapeutic goals were met and adapting strategies as necessary to maximize impact.
- Promoted awareness and education about autism within the wider community, contributing to a more inclusive environment for children and families.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school | N/A

- Planned and developed literacy and learning resources tailored for primary-aged children, focusing on making learning engaging and accessible for all students, including those with special educational needs.
- Created engaging classroom materials that supported reading and writing development, utilizing innovative design approaches to captivate children's attention and foster learning.
- Collaborated with teachers to align resources with lesson objectives, ensuring that all materials were relevant and effective in meeting educational standards.
- Adapted activities and resources to suit different learning needs and levels, resulting in a more inclusive classroom environment that promoted participation from all students.
- Conducted evaluations of resource effectiveness through student feedback and performance metrics, leading to continuous refinement and enhancement of educational materials.
- Trained educators in the use of new resources and strategies, empowering them to implement these tools effectively in their teaching practices.
- Developed a library of resources that teachers could easily access and utilize, promoting collaborative planning and resource sharing among staff.
- Spearheaded initiatives to incorporate technology into learning resources, enhancing engagement and interactivity for students.



EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire

 SKILLS

- Strong digital skills for resource creation
- layout
- and design
- Mind Express 5
- Widgit Online)
- Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS
- SymbolStix
- Widgit
- Bliss
- etc.)
- Understanding of inclusive communication
- SEN
- and speech and language therapy
- Collaboration with therapists
- educators

 HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Writing



Meditation



Art

 CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care (Preston College) - Focused on enhancing therapeutic relationships and understanding attachment theories.

Play Therapy (Canterbury Christ University) - Developed competencies in play-based therapeutic techniques and strategies for effective child engagement.

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy (Manchester) - Emphasized the importance of family involvement in therapy and techniques for enhancing family dynamics.